



WINE LAND

Northern California, the heart of America's wine country, produces a number of vintages that equal Europe's finest. Here, skilled workers in the Napa Valley harvest Cabernet Sauvignon grapes for one of the region's celebrated red wines.



THE FIFTH OF MAY

Mexicans living in the US celebrate their countries' friendship at the *Cinco de Mayo* (5th May) festival. Held in various cities (this one is San Diego), it honours a Mexican victory over the French in 1862.



As part of the *Cinco de Mayo* festival, dancers in long ruffled dresses take to the streets, twirling gracefully to traditional guitar music.



THE ALOHA STATE

Admitted to the union in 1959, modern-day Hawaii provides a tourist paradise for visitors from all over the world. Here, adorned with flowery leis around their necks, local girls perform their ancient ritual dance, the *hula*.

Back at the ranch

One of the industries on which Arizona was founded, cattle ranching is still important to the state's economy. Today, in addition to working ranches, there are many that cater to tourists wanting to experience cowboy life first hand. This one is in the Coconino National Forest.



RIDE 'EM COWBOYS

Virtually everywhere that cattle ranching is established, its essential skills—often in extreme and specialized form—are displayed as some kind of entertainment. Here, at the Green Days Rendezvous Rodeo in Wyoming, a courageous cowboy rides a bucking bronco.

